

The Renewal Timeline: From First Call to Bound Policy

A fleet-safety engagement is built around one immovable date: the day the policy expires. Everything below counts backward from it. The work starts early because the two things underwriters credit — documented evidence and a measurable trend — cannot be produced in the final weeks.

SEVEN-PHASE ENGAGEMENT OVERVIEW — T-120 TO T-0

T-120 – T-110 1. Nomination	T-120 – T-105 2. Engagement	T-105 – T-75 3. Assessment	T-90 – T-60 4. Submission	T-45 – T-30 5. Quotes	T-30 – T-0 6. Negotiate	T-0 onward 7. Verify
ACTORS:						
Broker		Fleet + Discern Verity		Discern Verity + Fleet		Broker + Discern Verity
						All three

The timeline at a glance

WHEN	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO ACTS
T-120 to T-110	1. Nomination	The broker flags an account facing a rough renewal — carrier has signaled an increase, loss runs look bad, or the market is hardening on that class	Broker
T-120 to T-105	2. Engagement start	One-page agreement signed: savings baseline defined in writing, verification source named, fee terms fixed. Fleet grants telematics export access	Fleet + Discern Verity
T-105 to T-75	3. Assessment (4–6 weeks)	Data audit → severity-weighted per-mile driver scorecards → coaching launches the moment the first scorecards exist (week 2–3, ~T-100) — the trend clock starts here, not when the packet ships → renewal packet v1 assembled	Discern Verity + Fleet
T-90 to T-60	4. Submission to market	Broker sends the renewal submission to underwriters at multiple carriers — application, loss runs, and the renewal packet riding inside it as the schedule-credit evidence	Broker
T-45 to T-30	5. Quotes return	Underwriters respond. Packet v2 — now carrying 8–10 weeks of measured coaching trend — arms the broker's negotiation for credits. If an underwriter wants the methodology explained, that call happens here	Broker, backed by Discern Verity
T-30 to T-0	6. Negotiation & binding	Broker pushes credits, terms finalize, policy binds at or before expiration	Broker
T-0 and after	7. Verification & renewal year	Savings verified off the binder and dec page — the broker's paperwork, not ours. Success fee triggers only now. Optional retainer year begins: weekly scoring, documented coaching, quarterly packet refreshes — so next year's renewal opens with twelve months of evidence instead of six weeks	All three

Who does what — the lanes never cross

ACTOR	THEIR LANE	WHAT THEY NEVER DO
The fleet	Grants data access, runs the coaching conversations with drivers, makes the operational calls (routing, scheduling)	Build the analysis or argue with underwriters
The broker	Nominates the account, owns the market submission, negotiates credits and terms, binds the policy	Produce the safety evidence — that's what they're handed
Discern Verity	Scores, coaches-by-the-numbers, documents, and writes the packet in the language underwriters credit	Touch placement, quotes, commission, or premium negotiation — ever
The underwriter	Prices the risk and grants (or withholds) discretionary schedule credits	Meet anyone from Discern Verity face-to-face — they meet the paperwork

Why the 90–120 day window — the arithmetic

The assessment takes 4–6 weeks. Starting at T–120 means packet v1 is finished **before the submission goes to market** — the only moment it can influence every carrier's quote. And a coaching *trend* needs weeks to exist: a driver improving from a 22 to a 68 is only visible if the measurement started two months before anyone asks. Start at T–120 and both are ready exactly when the submission leaves the broker's desk.

What late looks like:

- **T–60:** Possible, but compressed — packet v1 goes into a submission that's already moving, and the coaching trend is thin at quote time. The account should expect a weaker credit argument this cycle and a full-strength one next year.
- **T–45 or less:** Quotes are nearly final and schedule credits are already set. The honest answer is not a rush job — it's the **Bridge Plan** below: bind this year as best the market allows, start the program now, and walk into the *next* renewal with the strongest file in the market. A failed sprint costs more credibility than a redirected one.
- **A week before expiration:** Nothing can move. Binding is days away and every number is locked.

The Bridge Plan — when the account arrives too late

Too late for *this* renewal is the earliest possible start for the *next* one. The Bridge Plan turns a rushed loss into the deepest engagement the program offers:

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS
Now (T–45 to T–0)	The broker binds this year as best the market allows. The assessment starts immediately — the rough renewal becomes the documented "before" picture, in writing, with a date on it
First ~6 weeks	Assessment completes: driver scorecards, coaching program launched, packet v1 assembled — eleven months before anyone needs it
The retainer year	Weekly scoring, documented coaching, quarterly packet refreshes — faults found, fixed, and dated, window after window
Next cycle, T–90	The broker's submission opens with twelve months of measured evidence — the deepest packet this program produces, ready before any quote is asked

What this cycle still gets: baseline scorecards and a **program-commencement letter** the broker can drop into the final negotiation — a dated, third-party statement that an independent safety program is on the record. No promises attached; its job is to open the file, not to move this year's number.

The quiet advantage: the fleet that came in late ends up in the strongest position the following year. A full-year measured trend is the one thing no 90-day engagement can match — and the bad renewal it just ate becomes the baseline every improvement is measured against.

The trend clock — how much improvement v2 can honestly show

The gap between packet v1 and packet v2 is only ~5 weeks — but that is not the clock that matters. **Coaching starts at ~T-100, the moment the first scorecards identify the worst drivers — so by v2 at ~T-40, the coached drivers carry 8–10 weeks of measured behavior: two-plus full, independent 4-week scoring windows.** One window is a snapshot; two consecutive windows moving the same way is a direction.

EVIDENCE AT	WHAT IT HONESTLY SHOWS	WHAT IT SUPPORTS
v1 (~T-75, ~3 weeks of data)	A dated baseline, a third-party methodology, and a program management has committed to — not improvement yet	The program-existence half of the credit argument: safety organization and management cooperation are schedule-rating factors on their own
v2 (~T-40, 8–10 weeks of coached data)	Direction: the specific drivers driving the risk are measurably improving — per-driver before/after, high-severity behaviors falling per 1,000 miles	A modest, right-sized ask — points of schedule credit, or softening a large increase. Behavior data moves fast: a driver logs thousands of measured miles in two months, while claims data takes years
Second renewal (12 months of windows)	Proof: window after window, faults found, fixed, and dated	The full-strength credit argument

The line that keeps the packet credible: 8–10 weeks is enough to *argue* credits — not to *prove* a fleet is fixed. The loss runs at quote time are untouched by two months of coaching, and every underwriter knows it. So v2 never claims changed loss experience; it claims a working mechanism with early, measured direction that continues all year. The first cycle asks modestly — the second renewal collects in full.

The three deliverable moments

1. **Packet v1 (end of assessment, ~T-75)** — dated baseline, scorecards, program description, methodology. Its job is proving the program exists — not improvement. Goes into the broker's submission.
2. **Packet v2 (quote time, ~T-40)** — same structure plus **8–10 weeks of measured coaching trend**: two-plus independent scoring windows. This is the negotiation ammunition.
3. **The verified outcome (T-0)** — dec page confirms the bound premium against the written baseline. This is also the moment the case study for the next fleet is born.

The whole flow in one sentence

The broker hands over a fleet 120 days from a painful renewal; four to six weeks later the packet is inside the broker's market submission; by quote time it carries a measurable coaching trend; the broker negotiates with it; the policy binds; the savings are verified off the dec page — and the underwriter never met anyone. They met the evidence.

Discern Verity · Independent fleet-safety analytics · Chicago, IL · T-counts are calendar guides, not contractual deadlines — the agreement fixes actual dates per account.